1. Respectful and safe collaboration

1.1 Everyone working with Aster Vale Works Pvt. Ltd. must treat colleagues, applicants, customers and suppliers with dignity. Work discussions should address the issue, evidence and next step; insults, threats, humiliating jokes and repeated unwanted contact are not acceptable. This standard applies in the office, on calls, in work chat, at company events and during approved remote work.

1.2 Make room for colleagues to contribute. Do not interrupt repeatedly, take credit for another person's work, or exclude someone from a work discussion because of a personal characteristic. Give feedback privately where practical, describe the specific behavior or result, and invite a response. Managers must set clear expectations and correct conduct consistently, regardless of seniority or performance rating.

1.3 Disagreement about a decision is allowed. State the concern with relevant facts, listen to the response and use the assigned escalation route if the issue remains unresolved. Do not retaliate, threaten a schedule or rating change, or withhold necessary information because someone disagreed or raised a concern in good faith.

1.4 Keep work communication professional and limited to people who need the information. Do not post a colleague's private details, screenshots of confidential conversations or unverified allegations in a broad channel. If a record is needed to report a concern, preserve it and send it privately to the designated contact rather than editing, forwarding or publicly debating it.

1.5 A person who witnesses immediate risk of physical harm should contact local emergency services first, then notify the manager or People Support Desk when safe. Other concerns may be reported through the channels in section 4. A person may ask People Operations for help without first confronting the person whose conduct is in question.

2. Conflicts, gifts and responsible decisions

2.1 Disclose an actual, potential or perceived conflict of interest to the manager and People Operations within five working days of learning about it, and before taking a related decision. Examples include selecting a relative's business as a supplier, supervising a close family member, holding a financial interest in a bidder, or using company information for a personal opportunity. People Operations records the disclosure and may set a recusal or other safeguard.

2.2 Employees may accept an occasional modest business courtesy only when it is lawful, transparent and not intended to influence a decision. A gift, meal or event invitation worth more than INR 2,000 per giver per occasion must be declined or returned. If return is not practical, notify the People Operations Director within two working days and hand the item over for a documented disposition. Cash, gift cards and personal loans must never be accepted.

2.3 Record every accepted courtesy in the gift register within five working days, including giver, estimated value, date and business context. A manager cannot approve an exception to the INR 2,000 threshold. Any courtesy offered during a live tender, hiring decision or contract renewal must be declined regardless of value and reported to the department head.

2.4 Never offer a public official a gift, payment, favor or hospitality to obtain or retain business. Do not use a third party to do something this code prohibits. Ordinary business hospitality must be modest, related to a legitimate meeting and recorded through the Expenses Policy; reimbursement approval does not make an improper gift acceptable.

2.5 Use company property and information for authorized work. Do not copy customer lists, confidential plans or credentials to a personal account, or use them for a side business. Return devices and records when asked or when employment ends. Questions about a proposed outside role or close supplier relationship go to people@astervaleworks.example before the employee participates in the decision.

3. Confidentiality, records and use of resources

3.1 Access only the information needed for assigned work. Share confidential material through approved company systems with named recipients who have a business need. Verify recipients before sending, use access controls rather than public links, and follow the retention label on the record. Do not discuss restricted information in public places or leave printed material unattended.

3.2 Work records must be accurate, dated and complete enough for another authorized colleague to understand the decision. Never backdate an approval, falsify a receipt, alter a safety record or delete a record to avoid review. Correct an error by adding a dated correction and explanation through the system that owns the record.

3.3 Use company devices, accounts and funds primarily for work. Limited personal use is acceptable only when lawful, brief, does not create cost or security risk, and does not interfere with duties. Do not install unapproved software, share passwords, bypass security controls or use another employee's access. Report suspicious requests for credentials to servicedesk@astervaleworks.example.

3.4 When working remotely, follow the approved-location, device and privacy rules in the Remote Work Policy. When buying equipment or hosting a business meal, use the advance approvals and receipt requirements in the Expenses Policy. Policy references work together: a manager's verbal request does not override written spending or security controls.

3.5 If information is sent to the wrong recipient, a device is lost, or a record is exposed, notify servicedesk@astervaleworks.example immediately and no later than one hour after discovery when feasible. Preserve the message or device details and follow containment instructions. Do not conceal the incident or contact affected outsiders unless the response lead instructs you to do so.

4. Raising concerns and review process

4.1 Raise a concern with a manager, department head, People Operations Director or the confidential People Support Desk at people@astervaleworks.example. If the concern involves the manager, skip that person and contact another listed route. An urgent safety risk should be reported immediately; a non-urgent conduct concern should be reported within ten working days after discovery where practical.

4.2 Share dates, locations, people involved, relevant records and the outcome sought. Separate what was observed from what was heard from someone else. Do not conduct your own interviews, promise a particular outcome or circulate the report. The receiving contact acknowledges a report within two working days and normally provides an update within ten working days, even if the review is not complete.

4.3 People Operations assigns a neutral reviewer, limits access to those who need to assess or resolve the concern, and keeps a record of steps taken. The reviewer may speak separately with the reporter, the person named and relevant witnesses, and may request supporting records. The company aims to complete an ordinary review within 30 calendar days; a complex review may take longer, with an update explaining the delay.

4.4 Retaliation against someone who raises a good-faith concern, participates as a witness or asks for policy guidance is prohibited. A person who believes retaliation occurred should report it through a different contact route. Knowingly fabricated evidence or a deliberately false report may lead to corrective action, but a report is not misconduct merely because it cannot be substantiated.

4.5 Confirmed violations may result in coaching, training, a written warning, removal of access or further action consistent with law and employment terms. The company does not promise a specific outcome or disclose another person's confidential employment action. Ask people@astervaleworks.example for process questions. People Operations reviews this code each January and publishes the current revision date.